

NURALI KUNAYEV

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Chicago — B.S. Computer Science

Graduated May 2026

GPA: 3.86 / 4.00 — Magna Cum Laude

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Design, Database Systems, Object-Oriented Programming, Functional Programming, Data Science

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, C++, C#, SQL, JavaScript, Scala, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Tools: FastAPI, Firebase / Firestore, Flutter, React, Unity, Git / GitHub, Postman, Figma, Arduino

Concepts: Data Structures & Algorithms, OOP, REST API Design, Client-Server Architecture, Distributed & Real-Time Systems, Testing & Debugging, SDLC, Modular Design

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern | Beeline

Almaty, Kazakhstan | May – Aug 2024

Java · Python · REST APIs

- Engineered features for product-facing and internal tools in Java and Python with a focus on clean, modular, maintainable code.
- Built and debugged REST API integrations, improving reliability through testing, refactoring, and iterative fixes.
- Partnered with engineering and product to turn business requirements into shipped software across the full development lifecycle.

PROJECTS

BuySmart — AI Shopping Assistant

Feb 2026

Python · FastAPI · Chrome Extension · REST API

- Designed and deployed a Python/FastAPI REST service powering recommendation and shopping-insight endpoints that scanned live retailer pages for a companion Chrome extension.
- Shipped a working prototype with a 2-person team at SparkHacks 2026, owning the backend, extension client, and recommendation workflow end-to-end.
- Built product-matching and value-comparison logic to surface budget-aware recommendations and tradeoffs from scanned catalog data.

Smart Grocery — Cross-Platform Mobile App

Oct – Dec 2025

Flutter · Firebase Auth · Firestore

- Built a cross-platform Flutter app across multiple releases, covering the full SDLC from requirements through testing and iteration.
- Shipped 6+ user-facing features including personalized recommendations, swipe-based discovery, persistent grocery lists, and a quest/badge progression system.
- Integrated external recipe APIs with malformed-data handling and API key rotation, hardening reliability across releases.

TropeSearch — Full-Stack Web App

Oct – Dec 2025

JavaScript · Full-Stack · Team Project

- Built a web app to search films and TV shows by narrative tropes rather than genre, querying a 30K-trope dataset with 1.9M occurrences from TV Tropes.
- Developed the frontend search experience and supporting data pipeline as part of a semester-long team project.
- Structured the JavaScript codebase and integrated the large dataset into a responsive search interface in a team setting.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Co-Founder & Vice President — Kazakhstan Student Association (KSA), UIC

Feb 2025 – Present

- Co-founded UIC's Kazakhstan Student Association from the ground up, building its structure, leadership, and operations.
- Planned and executed 3 campus events with university offices and peer organizations, driving engagement and growth.

Member — Association of Kazakhstani International Students (AKIS)

Sep 2024 – Present

- Designed the UI/UX for the AKIS website to improve navigation and accessibility for members.
- Coordinated with student leaders across 5+ universities, growing new-member engagement by 30%.